

THE SPIRITUAL AND PRACTICAL MEANING OF "LET GO, LET GOD"

Greetings and divine blessings for all of you here, my dearest friends. With joy and love do I resume a new working season to give you all the assistance and guidance you could possibly require. Our growth process is a continuous one to the degree you truly desire it. It has already borne wonderful fruit, and it will continue to do so.

Everyone of you may find in the words I am privileged to speak this evening what he needs most now. If you try to listen with your inner ear, see with your inner eye, feel with your innermost being, and let the doubting mind rest -- at least for now -- you will find exactly what you need most for your development at this point.

I have often spoken the words, "Let go, let God." And you, when you meditate, also occasionally utter these words, "Let go, let God." Let us in this lecture examine the true meaning of this saying. What is understood by these words? There is a lot more to them than meets the eye, my friends.

Letting go obviously means letting go of the limited ego, its self-will, its narrow understanding and conceptions, its preconceptions, if you will. It means letting go of the fears, distrust, the misconceptions, and suspicion. But it also means letting go of insistence, of the attitude that says in effect that "I can only be happy if so and so does thus and thus or if life responds in no other way than I determine." This often appears as not wanting to give up something precious, something that is in itself legitimate and that you should indeed have. Does, then, giving up self-will, letting go mean to have to settle for unhappiness and unfulfillment? Is the striving for fulfillment that falls under the category of "letting go" wrong? These questions are important and we shall deal with them in this lecture.

To "let God" from the center of your being, from your heart, from your innermost self where God speaks to you if you wish to listen -- that is truly the ultimate aim. Before this highest, most blissful and secure state can exist, obstacles and dualistic confusions must always be removed.

It is usually so much easier to comprehend a philosophical concept, a spiritual premise in general terms than in its everyday applications. Your mundane reactions seem often too puny and insignificant to connect with the greater issues of life. Yet, it is exactly in this "insignificant" area that the key can be found to the confusions and conflicts which make it impossible to actually apply the great spiritual truths to your daily life.

We shall now try to deal with the confusion I mentioned. As in all things, the great truths can be distorted, and then they express themselves in a false way. Thus many people are aware of the fact and of the truth that the universe is benign and giving and that they are not required by divine

law to suffer. But it is their self-will that attempts to bring about the fulfillment they so ardently desire. To tell them that they must let go seems to imply that they must resign to emptiness, suffering, pain, and unfulfilled longing. Thus they hold on in a tight, squeezed way which in itself prohibits the influx of the greater world, of the deeper reality that is light, truth, love, abundance, and all imaginable fulfillment. The divine influx can only flow in its own harmonious rhythm when it is let loose. Energetically there must be no hard knots. Self-will, anxiety, insistence, forcing currents, distrust create an energetic climate that is antithetical to the divine flow. The state of consciousness that produces these tight, untrusting, insisting attitudes is antithetical to divine consciousness. An imbalance of trust exists. The little, limited ego is trusted while the greater divine self is negated. This does not mean that the ego should be denied. But it must be expanded in its creativity and wisdom precisely by allowing the divine influx to occur.

As you know, all attitudes create energy systems. The tightness of holding on, the not letting go, creates a closed energy system. On the outer level of existence this can easily be observed. Where tyranny and domination exist, where the will of a few power-driven individuals imposes itself over others, stemming from and creating more fear, the creative spark is squelched. A closed system always creates resistance even though temporarily some may outwardly submit to the force due to their own fears and weaknesses. But the time must come when every last fearful individual will stand up and throw off the shackles. History has always borne this out. In the confusion of the human mind, this healthy movement is often confused with a general rebelliousness that is coupled with and nourished by a childish will to refute genuine authority, truth, guidance, and the need for self-discipline and self-responsibility. Again, an imbalance may exist. On the one side, the person gives in where he should not -- submits, appeases, sells out. On the other, he rebels where he should not.

Inwardly the person rebels against the momentary uncertainty of stepping into an apparent vacuum after he has given up the tight self-will, after he ceases to hold on and begins to let go. Instead of trusting that process, he trusts false gods, whatever that may mean in each individual instance.

In interrelationships, it is easy to observe that the inner pressure, the subtle forcing current that says, for example, "You must love me," creates exactly the opposite response. The individual feels it is impossible to give up this demand because he does not want, cannot stand, not being loved. Isn't he entitled to it? Doesn't the universe grant him this so necessary fulfillment? How can he give up the demand and content himself with the bleak emptiness that he fears when he renounces this love? Yet, it is clear that the very demand, the very attitude of "you must," elicits everything else but love from the other. Love cannot blossom in a closed energy system. A closed system stems from distrust, non-love, power, and distortion of truth. Thus it cannot breed love.

You, who work on the path, constantly encounter in yourself this tightness, this fearfulness, this holding. You may call it, generally, resistance or give it many other names. Basically the resistance is not against a specific human being, a helper or a therapist, a teaching, or even against actual domination. For you do not need to be tightly holding against actual domination. The tight holding, the not letting go, fundamentally always exists in regard to the inner, spiritual struggle about what to trust: the little ego or God within. In order to do the latter, the interim states of consciousness the mind has produced and wishes to avoid must be "traveled through," as it were. And only too often, the self wishes to avoid what it has produced, whether this be pain or

confusion, emptiness or fear. Whatever the state, it must be embraced so that it can be explored, understood, and thus dissolved.

There is an enormous difference between believing that this temporary state is the final reality that must be kept in abeyance and knowing that it is a temporary condition. As long as the belief in the former exists, the self will either fight against letting go or it will resign into hopelessness and unhappiness.

This is why the resistance to letting go is so strong. You prefer the status quo in which you avoid falling into those other states of consciousness of your creation that must be traversed in order to let go and create and expand your life. You prefer the status quo, even though the state of letting loose, of letting God feels wonderful, rich, light, joyful, and safe. Many of you have begun to experience this more often. In that way the resistance to letting go diminishes gradually. It can never be done in one single decision. It is a decision and commitment that must be repeated many, many times.

The tightness you feel is so often traceable to the current, "I want it desperately." The desperation is, however, much more a result of the tightness that shuts out God than of not having what you want. The state of tightness stemming from fear, distrust, and a concept of poverty seems to justify your holding on. I repeat what I mentioned before: the giving up of the tight self-will implies, first of all, to let loose of the insistence of the wish. The wish must be let loose for the moment, which is quite different from giving it up forever. The who, where, what, when, and how of the wish fulfillment must be temporarily given up. When you have let go, you may even come back to the same "who, where, what, when, and how," but it will take place in a different emotional and spiritual climate. Often, though, your insistence to have the wish fulfilled in the one specific way that you now imagine, limits the actual fulfillment. If you give the creative process rope and margin, what you will then experience will by far surpass in happiness and fulfillment your hopes and visualizations. Since your mind is often incapable of even conceiving of the richness of the universe, you must learn to make yourself empty at the moment and allow the divine process to reveal itself to you. This means, "letting God."

It is sometimes true that you must give up the desire of the self-will which you do not want to let go of. But this is only temporarily true. If you have inwardly accumulated a negative image of your own life in which you can only suffer, then you must examine and oust this image so as to inactivate its energetic power. This cannot happen in a state of holding on and fighting against this same innermost negative belief.

If you send out currents of domination over others with whom you are involved in relationships; if you fight against their imperfections and immaturities that hurt you, it is only because you do not trust that your inner God can produce fulfillment for you without having to impose your ideas over others no matter how right these ideas may be in theory.

Mankind is caught in this conflict: you either hold on against the blankness, pain, and abandonment you fear will be your fate if you let go, or you resign into this dismal state in order not to hold on. It is a universal conflict, part and parcel of the dualistic state of mind of this dimension of consciousness. As you have often heard me explain, there are many, many other such confusions and conflicts in which mankind is involved and of which it must laboriously find its way out. In this

particular instance, either he uses a forcing current, or he resigns to a negative state and becomes hopeless and harbors a negative concept of life. This seldom applies to all areas of life expression, but it almost always applies to some.

You may outwardly tend toward one of these manifestations, but the other also lives within you, concealed even from your own awareness. Let us say that you are outwardly forceful, aggressive, and temperamentally suited to getting away with overriding others by sheer force, clever persuasion, or dishonest manipulation. In that case, you use some of your resources in order to cover up resignation, despair, hopelessness, and distrust in life (always in certain areas only). Or, you are outwardly a personality type who above all wants, to get along with others, who wants to depend on them and not antagonize them. Then, underneath, there must be the desire to dominate. Often such domination is obtained by submission. "I will do what you say so that you are bound to me and will have to obey my wishes. You will be too guilty to offend me when I have proven to be so obedient to you." I venture to say that you must have found such hidden attitudes in the course of your pathwork.

Whatever the outer manifestation of these two ways to react in life may be, the opposite of the overt manifestation must also exist in you. You may have become quite aware of the manifest attitude but may still be deluded in thinking that the opposite does not exist in you. He who is outwardly dominant will find it difficult to deal with the inner hopelessness. He who is outwardly negative, dependent, weak, and submissive will find it difficult to deal with his covert dominant, manipulative traits. They are inevitably two sides of the same coin.

At the beginning of the path of self-exploration, you may not be aware of even the overt personality aspect. And I say this for the number of new friends on the path. But little by little as you observe yourself, you will become aware first of the overt, then the covert side of the unit.

When the personality is very adept in its chosen way of "dealing with the world," he finds it most difficult to recognize the hidden aspect. If an individual is forceful by nature, has aspects of strength that he partially puts into the service of the forcing current, he may for a long time "get away" with this "solution" to ward off the disaster he secretly believes in. If the individual is by nature soft and pliant but uses these assets in order to manipulate others and hide the domination he would wish to exert, he may find it extremely difficult to give up the former and face the latter. If you seem to get what you want through your chosen way and your personality predominance, it is much harder to see what you miss. Only when life finally brings home to you that your succeeding is an illusion and that you are actually fighting an already existing state of emptiness which is the result of your chosen "solution," will you be sufficiently motivated to deal with this struggle.

You may momentarily seem to get, or even actually get, what you want, but you do not really get what you yearn for. You do not get the real fulfillment you continually make impossible by the very use of these "solutions." Let us assume you wish love and closeness with another human being, but feel uncertain that you will obtain this desire through his or her own free will. Let us further suppose you then rule by possessiveness, domination, jealousy, coercion, demands. (This can occur in either the overt or covert way. You can rule just as much by weak dependency, blame, and guilt-producing games like "poor me," etc.). If the other person partially truly loves you but partially neurotically needs you or wants to exploit you, he or she will submit to your rule but must resent and blame, hate, and defy you for it although he becomes party to the arrangement. Thus, even

when you "succeed," it means little, because you are constantly fighting against those reactions for which you are co-responsible. These negative reactions in the other only strengthen your negative image of life. And so it goes on and on. But what will happen if you have the courage and integrity of letting the reins go, notwithstanding the fear that you might lose this person? If you lose, what have you lost? But if you "win," you find the immense joy of discovering that the other wants to love you freely without your coercion, manipulation, domination. That is the true richness you long for. And even if you lose that person, does this truly have to mean that you must be alone forever or that what you hope for from a specific relationship cannot come otherwise? Certainly not. But you may temporarily have to dip into your bleakness so as to dissolve its power to present an obstruction. In that way, you can "let God."

Divine creation means you to have all the bliss imaginable. If you can confront your doubts in this, in that the best could indeed be yours, then you can establish trust. But trust and faith cannot be built over the rotten foundation of distrust and lack of faith. If all the energy you now use in order to coerce and bend your environment would be used to establish genuine faith in the abundance of life, in the richness your life could have, you would indeed create such a rich life. Covering up your lack of faith, your distrust, your negative outlook, and then covering up the means you use in order to "overcome" them, consumes valuable, essentially creative energy.

I specifically suggest that all of you look at both the overt and covert manifestations of this struggle in you and in what areas of your life they exist. Look at the lack of faith that must exist when you do not let God, when letting go seems to connote resignation into an unfulfilled state. Feel the inner movement in you when you cease grabbing, and then visualize yourself in a confident, patient, humble state of mind in which the universe can give you its best.

Whether you experience your outer holding or whether you experience your outer hopelessness that you can never have the best of life, try to get in touch with its hidden opposite. Both facets should be on the surface. Become fully conscious of both aspects. Only then will you be able to find the key which I will give you here now. However, hearing about this key can never be sufficient although it will surely help you find the right direction. It requires a great deal of inner work for you to use this key.

Before speaking about this key, I would like to say a little more about this topic of "letting go, letting God" as regards your interactions with others. I already mentioned the apparent conflict of wanting to be loved, respected, appreciated, and your pushing for it; I spoke about your dilemma, about apparently having to give up this wish, and your confusion whether you are entitled to it or not. I must repeat here, for it is so important, that whatever rightful claim you make into creation, the universe cannot accommodate you when your condition is a cramped, forcing, hopeless, negative one. Nor is the "you must love me" an expression of genuine love on your part. Love and "must" are antithetical. Forcing does not allow freedom to the other. An open energy system always functions in freedom. The attitude of such an open energy system would, in effect, be somewhat like this: "I would like you to love me. You seem the person I would like to share myself with, to whom I would like to give all of myself. If you are such, I know that you must come to me in freedom, freely out of your own volition. Even if my forcing could really affect you, I would not want it this way. I trust the universe to give me what is my fair due. If you do not wish this freely, I can let you go from deep within and wait in faith that the person who will appreciate and freely want what I have to give will come to me." This reflects an open energy system and is a compatible

attitude with the available abundance. This abundance constantly floats around you, but a clogged energy system erects a wall that closes you off from this ever present abundance. Of course the same principle applies to all other kinds of relationships, to wanting a specific job, wanting friends, wanting people who buy what you have to sell, who take from you what you have to give, or who give you what you look for.

A closed energy system, an attitude of tightly holding on is really your false and inefficient weapon against a negative vision of the universe you live in, a vision of life for you, at least, if not generally speaking. The weapon is wielded with ever stronger forcefulness as it proves itself inefficient. You become more forceful, more possessive, demanding, jealous, dominating. Thus the energy system closes more and more tightly and shuts out life's riches. Your illusion of life's negative nature is strengthened, and you fight against this illusion, this negative vision so as not to fall into the pit of resignation and giving up instead of letting go.

You must live in an open energy system in order to reach out into life and comfortably, confidently claim its riches. You must be rich yourself in order to be energetically compatible with the riches of the universe. And in a closed energy system, you believe yourself a pauper and never avail yourself of your riches. Knowing your riches implies, as the first substantial step, to be strong enough, generous enough, humble enough, honest enough not to exert force over others no matter how subtly this force may be acted out. Not letting go is a forcing current. Forcing, no matter how concealed, amounts to stealing because you know you would not have to enforce anything if it were indeed freely given you. The irony is that often what wants to be given you freely becomes inaccessible when you force. Thus not letting go must violate your integrity on a deep level which then causes you to doubt yourself and your rights to be happy. Not letting go can be equated with being a "stealing beggar." Letting go can be equated with knowing one's ultimate riches with the willingness to establish this fact in your consciousness. Letting go thus implies a hard, honest look at your illusions, your pretenses, and your dishonesties.

As you know, thoughts and energies constantly create. There is an enormous difference between creating a closed system by manipulation (manipulation of others, of facts, of events, of the creative energies around you) or creating an open energy system by trust.

The key you have to learn is letting go into trust. And in order to trust, you must first establish certain intermediate links. They cannot be skipped. Those links form the bridge to a state of genuinely positive expectation of life. In this state, there is no pressure, there is no anxiety, there is no doubt. There is the deep faith that the universe is benign and that you can have the best, the very best on all levels of existence. This is the key we are concerned with here.

An open energy system in which you can positively create fulfillment and enrichment requires that you discover your inner richness. You must become rich. If you start from your poverty, you can never create an open energy system. You can, at best, create a closed energy system in which you directly or indirectly rule, coerce, pressure, command, demand, and manipulate -- and in which you cheat!

The open energy system which creates the richness that flows into you from within and from without must come from your own richness that can afford to lose at the moment, that can afford to take the temporary pain of finding the real obstruction against the unfulfilled need and to

ultimately remove it through a change of inner attitude. This is the way you can create richness from poverty.

There is a sequence of steps that must be undertaken in this process. Step number one is that you must recognize the conflict we have just discussed: your struggle between hopelessness and a pushing, holding, pressuring on top. Step number two is that you must see that this conflict exists because you operate from the premise of an imaginary poverty, from a conviction that you cannot have what you need if you give up the pushing, holding, pressuring struggle. You believe that you must be condemned to not experiencing what you long for and what your personality needs in order to thrive. Step number three is that you must be totally committed to working out the real reasons for the fulfillment in the usual way you learn on this path. This must be done in a spirit of honesty, of perseverance, of patience and humility. By humility I mean that instead of blaming the universe for your poverty in a particular area of your life, you search for your distortions that have created this poverty.

Most human beings have some areas in which they feel themselves rich and some in which they feel impoverished and therefore needy. It is hardly, especially among people like you, all one way. So you must discover which is the area in which you feel rich and which is the area in which you feel poor. Perhaps you feel rich in certain creative talents where you feel completely confident, at ease, and where you sense that you have this limitless abundance within you. There you feel like a well that never ceases to flow. But at the same time, you may feel poor in regard to ever finding true mutuality. Another person may feel very secure in that area but feel very doubtful that he can ever have abundance and security on the financial level. You all know by now how to search for the inner reasons for such a condition, so I will not go into details about the how. You know that misconceptions, negative intentionality, destructive attitudes must exist. Now, I only want to say this: you have to be quite clear where you feel rich and where you feel poor. Where you feel rich, you will always be rich because you must also have a giving and honest attitude. But where you feel poor, you will continue to be poor until you establish richness within through giving and honesty.

It would be helpful if you compared your feelings and your attitudes toward yourself in giving and in honesty so as to differentiate between your richness and your poverty.

Now, in actuality the richness exists always with everyone. But if you do not know that you possess that richness, if you are blind to it, you will truly believe and experience only your poverty. The poorer you believe yourself to be, the more you must react as if you had nothing to give. How often have you found in the course of this path, in you and others, that feelings are held in check because giving them seems to create unendurable emptiness that can only be filled by others?

Let us see then what happens when you believe yourself to be poor. I said before that every kind of pushing, domineering, forcing, manipulating amounts to cheating. If we were to translate such an attitude into concise words, these would say, in effect: "I force you to give me what you do not want to give me. If my straight power is not adequate enough, I shall do so by trickery. I shall make you feel guilty for not giving me what I want from you. I shall accuse and blame you for victimizing me. I shall turn it all around and accuse you of doing what I secretly do to you. For instance, I shall claim that you dominate me because you refuse to comply with my goal to force you into submission to me." It is easy to see that this has nothing to do with love. Such an attitude is

unfair, cheating, prohibitive, and infringes on the other person's freedom -- or at least it attempts to do so.

The free, open, loving attitude, according to the open energy system, says: "I would be happy to have your love; but loving you, I shall give you the freedom to come to me if and when you choose. If you do not wish to love me, I have no right to make you feel guilty by pretending that this devastates me." This is the true honesty, decency, and integrity that creates richness. You are entitled to want to be loved or to have money or to have fulfillment, but if you go about it any other way, your means become prohibitive and, in the deepest sense, dishonest. Because you feel poor you think you must steal and because you continue stealing, you remain poor, for only the honest can feel deserving of riches. The energetic form of the forcing, holding attitude is that of a tight prison or a short leash.

Stealing creates guilt and the guilt produces doubt that you are entitled to have freely. Right here you place yourself into a climate of impoverishment in which you must indeed doubt your capacity to create richness. And you violate spiritual law. It is extremely important to find out in what way you do so.

Along the way, you will also find your lack of faith that the universe will yield what it wants to give you. You make it impossible for the universe to give to you because of the closed energy system you have established. It is exactly the same in a relationship. Even the best relationship and the most genuine love, if it is forced and coerced, will automatically be withheld. Your demand for it will be resented even by those who comply due to their own neurotic motives. You do not allow yourself to receive the existing or growing love because of the prohibitive energy form: an attitude of unfairness and dishonesty must exist when you grab, when you do not let go and let God. Pressure creates counter pressure. Letting go affords the possibility to experience genuine divine law, that is, to experience what is. And what may be there temporarily -- darkness, negativity -- must be seen for what it is, so that what is ultimately -- light and beauty -- can reveal itself. Only when you let go, can others be free to love you.

You may indeed be entangled in a relationship where, in freedom, love does not come forth. But this is only so because your distortions and your concept of impoverishment in this area will draw to you someone who is incapable of giving you love. You may have to let go first of what you want from a specific person and accept the momentary, apparent state of impoverishment and emptiness. You must travel through it until you can find through your own increasing inner health, freedom, and richness that it is given to you freely. And once you have tasted the difference between what you get through pressure and control and what you get when you let free, you will never desire the former any more. The former is indeed meaningless. It cannot enrich you because you extracted it out of your own sense of poverty -- a false sense of poverty, but nevertheless a sense of poverty.

The richness that is necessary for having and being and living in an open energy system in which people, love, richness, and the universe come to you freely, you can only create when you give as fully as you wish to receive. These words have often been spoken by all religions and philosophies of value. They are surely not new. But so often giving is a false mask, a ploy that only hides the cheating, the bargaining, and the dishonesty, the selling out, and the negativity that are present in the heart. Since the inner world of true interaction cannot be deceived, you must reap

according to what actually exists on this deeper level and not according to what you wish to believe exists in you. This is why letting go so often means, at first, to plunge into this inner negative world that you have created and hidden from the world and from your own awareness. But you should also remind yourself that this is not the ultimate you to which you are either doomed or from which you must hide. By admitting its existence, you can change it.

The honesty of self-facing includes courage and humility. This never induces hopelessness even if you first examine the world of poverty you have created in your consciousness and experience its pain as a tunnel through which you travel in the spirit of not avoiding what is your creation. But you must stay poor when you deny this process and choose to feel victimized by life because of the pain you have created out of ignorance, dishonesty, and negativity.

Out of that courage, the further attitude of letting go must grow. In essence this means: "If others want what I have to offer, I will gladly give it to them. If they do not want it, I will let them go. If this is painful, I will accept this pain and explore its origin in me. I will trust in the ultimate benign nature of life to give me what I need even if, at the moment, I am still not capable of experiencing it."

This meditation, my friends, must be the final step in the sequence I outlined so as to extricate yourself from an incredibly painful and hopeless dichotomy in which all mankind is basically involved. One person is more involved in it than another; nevertheless every human being is trying to get out of this pattern although some are caught in it only to a small extent. You create richness and an open energy system by seeing how your demands defeat your fulfillment, by seeing how your demands and your tight holding imply an insult to the universe. The demand says, "I do not believe I can have, unless I push, pressure, cheat, manipulate, and force it to me."

When you undertake these steps, you must release first the holding, and you must let go of what you acquired through this forcing attitude, through self-will and pressure. This means you may not immediately obtain from the outside what you desire. You must first create the inner attitude in which you can accept the not having in good grace and still feel (or just because of it) your inner wealth. The capacity to do without what you want will enhance your self-esteem and your integrity, and this will begin to enrich you from within your own resources. Then the fulfillment from without becomes almost secondary. Perhaps secondary is not quite the right word. What I want to convey is that there is often a genuine need for outer wish fulfillment but that such fulfillment must become a natural by-product of your inner state. Also it must not be something you cannot do without. If that is the case, you are centered in others and not in your own being. The outer fulfillment, important as it may be, is simply an organic development of your inner state. First that inner state in you must be established, the state in which you can let go of what you want to have even if you feel empty, painful, needy -- but always with a view that there is another state of consciousness beyond, into which you can flow by not having to resist the present state. This is the way to establish the inner state which is compatible with universal law, with creation that is forever ready to give you whatever you truly need to be happy.

I want to say a few words about guilt, which is very important, especially in connection with this topic. I want to discuss the difference between guilt, shame, and remorse. I occasionally discussed this in the past. I often refer to justified and unjustified guilt. I also often speak about the

destructive nature of guilt that devastates the self and prohibits the vision of the ultimate divine self. Now let us see in what way guilt, shame and remorse differ from one another.

When you feel guilty, you say in effect: "I am beyond redemption, I deserve to be devastated." Since you are an integral part of creation, of the universe, of God, you thus insult yourself as much as when you do not trust life's abundance, goodness, safety, justice, richness, and beauty. No matter how negative, destructive, mean, malicious, spiteful, dishonest, and manipulative you discover a part of you to be, it is only one part, only a temporary aspect which the real you has brought into material manifestation in order to recognize and to alter it. It never means that this is all of you; you must beware of this dangerous distortion.

There is a direct correlation between this self-devastating guilt and the distrust of life. It is essential that you deal with this double-edged distortion and set it right. In this kind of guilt, you inevitably cut yourself off from your own divine streaming. Thus you have to immediately go to the opposite extreme in which you whitewash your actual failings and faults, those areas that need to be faced squarely and honestly. Thus the defense against your shortcomings is always correlated with a self-devastating guilt. And the self-devastating guilt is correlated with a denial of the true nature of an all-giving, all-loving, all-fulfilling universe for all created beings. Beware of this guilt, my friends, for it does not lead to self-purification. It is not a realistic or constructive attitude.

Now what about shame? Shame is the emotion or the attitude that is concerned with vanity and with appearance. Perhaps you are ashamed to expose something in front of others because you want to pretend to be other than what you are. The ego image takes predominance over what really is. Thus you lose touch with the treasure of your real self. So there is a difference between guilt and shame. Guilt deals with yourself, your own devastation, your exaggeration, which occurs as a kind of game. Shame applies to your image, your pretenses toward the world outside.

True remorse has nothing to do with either guilt or shame. It simply recognizes your shortcomings, limitations, faults, impurities, negativities. It admits that there are parts in you in which you violate spiritual law and thus violate your deepest integrity. To admit this; to feel regretful in a realistic spirit; to recognize that these impurities are a useless waste and inflict harm on others and yourself; to sincerely want to change them and not shirk the patience and hard work, the humility and pain of necessary self-confrontation, is entirely different from self-devastating guilt or from shame. Remorse makes it possible to say: "Yes, it is true, I have this or that dishonesty, pettiness, false pride, hatred, malice (or whatever), but this is not all of me. The very fact that I can recognize it, feel regretful about it, want to change it, allies me with my divine self which will ultimately win over these aspects I have remorse about." The "I" that dislikes and wants to change destructive, untruthful, deviating aspects remains basically intact even if it sees this or that amiss. So, do make the distinction between guilt, shame, and remorse. And see that guilt is very much part of a lack of faith in all that is.

Now my dearest beloved friends, there are many spiritual helpers here around you and around everyone who is venturing on such a path of self-development. Some of you may doubt the reality of spiritual existence beyond the body, but whether or not you have these doubts, it is a fact. There is a whole, for you, intangible world which is extremely tangible in reality. In fact, it is much more tangible than the world you know as real. The world you know as real is a reflection, a mirror image, an outer projection your real self is thrust into in order to fulfill a task. Give the free gift of real love

by letting others be, even if this means a loss at the moment. Let go in trust and faith that life wants to shower you with its gifts. The more you thus establish an attitude of truth in you, the more will you know the inner beauty, the inner world of reality that can never perish.

We are starting a new working year in which even more progress and expansion can be expected. You see this movement progresses year after year in ever accelerating beauty regardless, or rather, because of the difficulties you occasionally have to master. This movement is bound to continue and increase as long as you persevere on your genuine path. Your growth becomes more and more tangible; you resolve your problems in an ever more profound way; and your experience of joy and security, peace and pleasure becomes deeper, longer lasting, and less fraught with subsequent fearful contraction. You become more capable of fulfillment because of your honest investment in facing yourself in truth. Divine blessings are with you. Be in peace.

For information to find and participate in Pathwork activities world wide, please write:

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